Joint Force Capabilities and Limitations

Situation Report

Note: You are on the GCC planning staff for USGEOCOM, the 18-country region shown in the map. The transcript of the commander's situation report follows:



Commander's Briefing

This is the situation report regarding the events now developing in Teurnia. The content of this report is unclassified.

Here you see the map of the USGEOCOM. Most of you have previously worked in this region, so we will just focus on Teurnia and Ravenna.

The purpose of this operation is to deter a possible invasion of Teurnia by Ravenna and, if that fails, to restore Teurnia's territorial integrity while destroying as much of Ravenna's offensive military capability as possible. At this time, Ravenna poses an imminent threat to Teurnia and deterring its offensive action is considered unlikely.

Because Ravenna greatly outnumbers Teurnia in all meaningful military capabilities, US forces must deploy a joint force capable of providing all of the joint functions while operating from host nation bases and integrating with host nation forces. Any invasion of Teurnia by Ravenna must be quickly culminated, and the military outcome must be decisively in Teurnia's favor.

Given the relatively open terrain in Teurnia and the lack of significant natural barriers, US forces must be deployed to Teurnia and into combat quickly to concede as little of Teurnia's territory as possible. This will reduce Ravenna's ability to consolidate control and minimize collateral damage to Teurnia.

In support of culminating Ravenna's invasion, US air and maritime forces will conduct key strategic strikes on Ravenna C2 and offensive capabilities that support the invasion of Teurnia.

In addition, US forces will ensure that Ravenna's maritime forces play no role in offensive action against Teurnia and that any that do so are destroyed. The opportunity should also be taken to degrade Ravenna's significant shore-based antiship missile systems that have long posed a threat to sea lines of communication in the region.

Due to a need to avoid the impression that the US wishes to escalate the conflict, no US ground forces will cross into Ravenna, nor will US forces conduct strikes on overtly political or economic targets, or on military targets not involved in action against Teurnia.

Once Ravenna's invasion is culminated, US and host nation forces will attrit Ravenna's invasion forces as much as possible until these forces retreat and/or collapse and depart Teurnia's territory.

Upon the reestablishment of Teurnia's control of its territory, the role of US forces will shift to immediate security, border control, and relief assistance. It will then transition to the support and training of Teurnia's forces and the reconstruction efforts of the US interagency and international community.

Once Teurnia's governance has been reestablished throughout the country and Teurnia's forces are in position to defend Teurnia's own border, US combat forces will be removed from Teurnia.

Are there any questions? OK then, let's get to work. The people of Teurnia are counting on us to get this right.

Mission Statement

The online activity presents a list of subtasks as well as two lists: a function library and a force elements library. You have two sets of tasks to accomplish. First, identify the joint function that incorporates the subtask, and second, identify the assets from the force element library that can most effectively complete the subtask. The joint functions can be used multiple times, but the forces in the element list can be used only once.

Review

This activity was designed to help you understand service capabilities and limitations when considered in a joint operation. We hope you have gained an understanding and appreciation for both the scope of joint operations and the capabilities that the services can provide. Importantly, while each service has distinct capabilities, there is overlap especially when considered at the operational level of war. In a

complex operational environment, the joint force commander may be faced with hundreds of subtasks that extend across multiple phases of the campaign. When applying the capabilities of various service elements to meet these tasks, commanders must decide which asset is not only capable of completing the mission, but whether that asset may be better employed elsewhere. By organizing the mission through the joint functions and various subtasks, the joint force commander is better able to create a plan that maximizes force capabilities and minimizes limitations. Understanding these similarities and differences, and then applying them, is critical to operational effectiveness and the success of joint operations.